UNIT 2

Workflows, Processes and Conflict Resolution

Ampliación de Lengua Extranjera

This course is divided into four instructional units that develop the linguistic and professional competencies necessary for students to operate successfully in international environments.



INSTITUTOS NEBRIJA

Course Evaluation

Assessment is continuous and combines attitude, milestones and final testing.

Assessment item	Weight
Activities & Attitude	25%
First milestone: Podcast	25%
Second milestone: Brand Fair	25%
Final Exam	25%

Important conditions

To pass, students must achieve at least 5 in both milestones and the final test.

Learning Outcomes are assessed in all of them.

Failed milestones or final tests must be retaken in the ordinary sitting, and ultimately in the extraordinary sitting.

The second milestone is group-based, but it will be adapted for individual assessment if retaken.

Attendance and Continuous Assessment Rules

Absence limits affect which tasks students must sit in the ordinary exam session.

⚠️ You need a 7 or higher in English subjects to study in York, access Erasmus or work in the U.S.

Loss of 15% in a term

If the student exceeds 15% absences in a term, they must sit the checkpoints or tasks completed during that period in the ordinary exam session.

This applies even if they had previously passed some of them.

Loss of 20% in the full course

If the absence rate exceeds 20% over the entire course, the student must sit all tasks in the ordinary exam session.

This applies even if they have already passed some of them.

If the student does not pass in the extraordinary session, they must re-enrol in a later course.

Contents of Unit 2

Five content areas applied to formal and professional contexts.

Area	Focus
Vocabulary	Workflows, processes, and conflict resolution
Reading	Reading comprehension texts related to applied workplace English
Listening	Listening activities related to applied workplace English
Speaking	Process Handover
Writing	Semi-formal email about a technical issue

Vocabulary

Planning and running work reliably in IT.

Build language to plan and run IT workflows reliably.

Describe end-to-end workflows and talk about blockers and bottlenecks calmly.

Integrate cybersecurity and AI into the process.

Outline a simple SOP, name owners and steps, and explain what happens when something breaks.



Agile and Scrum

Agile uses short cycles and frequent feedback; Scrum adds sprints and clear events.

Term	Definition	Example
agile development	A methodology focused on iterative development, flexibility, and collaboration.	We run two-week Agile sprints.
scrum	A framework with sprints, a backlog, and inspection events.	Add this user story to the Scrum backlog.
sprint	A fixed time period to deliver value.	This sprint ends on Friday.
backlog	A prioritized list of pending work.	Put the security tasks at the top of the backlog.

Agile and Scrum: Key Workflow Terms

Use these terms to describe blockers, progress and flow.

Term	Definition	Example
user story	A requirement written from the user point of view.	Write a user story for password reset.
acceptance criteria	Conditions that define when work is done.	Add acceptance criteria for error messages.
daily stand-up	A short daily sync to share progress and blockers.	Mention your blocker in the stand-up.
kanban	A visual method that limits work-in-progress.	Set a WIP limit on “In Progress”.
bottleneck	The part that limits performance of the process.	Code review is our bottleneck.
blocker	An impediment that stops a task.	Missing credentials are a blocker.

Delivery Workflows

Build → Test → Deploy → Rollback

Workflows make delivery repeatable: clear steps, owners, and guardrails reduce errors and speed recovery when tests fail or deployments break.

Term	Definition	Example
build	The process of compiling or packaging software.	The build failed in CI.
test	Running checks to find errors or verify behavior.	Add tests for login failures.
deploy	Releasing a version to an environment.	Deploy to staging first.
rollback	Returning software to a previous version after issues.	Rollback if errors increase.

Delivery Workflows: Runtime and Release

Vocabulary for deployment contexts and configuration.

Term	Definition	Example
release	A specific version made available for use.	Ship the 1.2 release today.
runtime	The environment where a program executes.	Configure the Java runtime.
environment variables	Key–value settings used at runtime.	Set DB_HOST as an env var.
image	A packaged copy of software used for deployment.	Build a new image after fixes.

Operational Conflict Resolution

Protect the workflow: identify blockers, align on a path, and avoid blame.

Term	Definition	Example
root cause	The fundamental reason for a problem.	We found the root cause: a bad driver.
workaround	A temporary method to keep work moving.	Use the workaround until we patch.
escalation	Moving an issue to a higher level for help.	Escalate to networking if the link is down.
handoff	Passing work with the right context to the next owner.	Write a clear handoff note.
SLA	A target time or quality inside the team process.	Code review SLA is 24 hours.
WIP limit	A cap on tasks being worked on at once.	Respect the WIP limit to reduce context switching.

Let’s Practice: Word Formation

Use the word given in capitals to form the correct word for each gap.

1. Agile development requires close _____ between developers and clients. COLLABORATE
2. The team decided to _____ the most urgent tasks in the backlog. PRIORITY
3. Good _____ is essential when working on a software project. COMMUNICATE
4. The team needs a clear _____ of the user’s needs before starting development. DESCRIBE
5. The developers were unable to continue because of a technical _____. BLOCK
6. The team found a temporary _____ while they were fixing the main problem. WORK
7. The _____ of the new version was delayed because of testing problems. RELEASE
8. The software failed because of an incorrect system _____. CONFIGURE
9. The team decided to _____ the problem to the IT manager. ESCALATE
10. The new process has improved the speed and _____ of software delivery. EFFICIENT

Cybersecurity in the Workflow

Security is part of every step: building, testing and deploying with the least risk possible.

Term	Definition	Example
access control	Mechanisms to manage who can use resources.	Tighten access control on staging.
least privilege	Give only the permissions required.	Use least privilege for service accounts.
hardening	Reducing attack surface by secure settings.	Apply OS hardening after install.
audit log	A record of actions and changes.	Add changes to the audit log.
failover	Switching to a standby system after failure.	Test firewall failover monthly.

AI in the Workflow

AI tools can assist with repetitive tasks and triage, but humans decide and review.

Term	Definition	Example
automated test generation	Using tools to create tests faster.	Use AI to draft test cases.
log triage	Rapidly classifying errors and alerts.	AI helps with log triage overnight.
code suggestion	Proposals for small code changes.	Review AI code suggestions before merge.
anomaly detection	Finding unusual patterns in metrics/logs.	Enable anomaly detection for latency.

Let’s Practice: Match Term and Definition

Match each term (1–10) with the correct definition (A–K).

Terms	Definitions
1. Sprint	A. A saved system or VM state at a specific time.
2. Backlog	B. A short daily sync to share progress and blockers.
3. Rollback	C. Giving only the minimum permissions required.
4. Orchestrator	D. A prioritized list of pending work.
5. Acceptance criteria	E. Conditions that define when work is done.
6. Hardening	F. Temporary pause on non-urgent changes before a release.
7. Least privilege	G. Returning software to a previous version after issues.
8. Bottleneck	H. Software that automates container deployment and scaling.
9. Snapshot	I. Security configuration to reduce attack surface.
10. Daily stand-up	J. The slowest step that limits process flow.
	K. A fixed time box to deliver value.

Let’s Practice: Fill the Gaps

Text 1: From backlog to deployment

Word bank: backlog, orchestrator, bottleneck, build, deploy, metrics, rollback, acceptance criteria

⚠ There is one extra term you won’t need to use.

To start the sprint, the team refines the _____ and sets clear _____. During development, they keep a strict WIP limit to avoid a _____ at code review. When the _____ completes, tests run automatically; if they fail, the team fixes issues before _____. For release day, they deploy to staging first and monitor _____ and logs. If errors spike, they _____ to the previous version and write a short handoff note for the next shift.

Let’s Practice: Fill the Gaps

Text 2: Security in the workflow

Word bank: audit log, least privilege, snapshot, escalation, hardening, failover

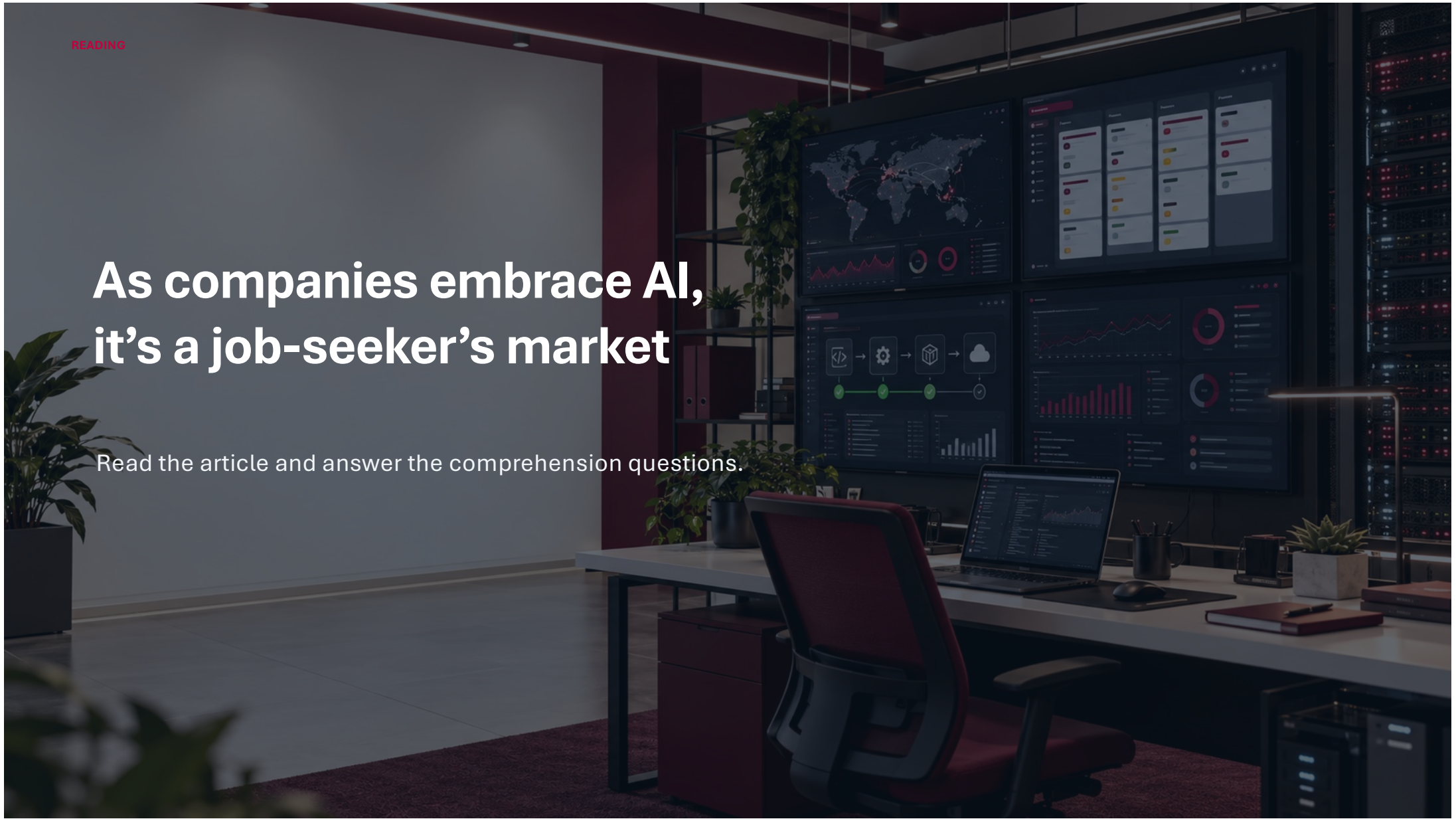
⚠️ There is one extra term you won’t need to use.

Before deployment, engineers review _____ to confirm who changed what. They apply OS _____ and enforce _____ so services run with only the permissions they need. In parallel, the firewall _____ test runs during a quiet window. Finally, they capture a VM _____ and store it safely, so any failure can be reversed without panic.

READING

As companies embrace AI, it’s a job-seeker’s market

Read the article and answer the comprehension questions.



Reading Text: AI Talent Demand

Part 1

In September, dozens of employers crowded the University of California, Berkeley's electrical engineering and computer sciences career fair to hire students with AI skills. Among them was Boris Yue, 20, who wasn't worried about competition. He studies artificial intelligence — technology that trains machines to learn and make decisions — and "there is no shortage of machine learning opportunities," he said.

AI is moving from labs into products and workplaces: cars that assist or drive themselves, robots that identify weeds, tools that help detect skin cancer, and smart home devices. In higher education, AI even supports online teaching assistants. As applications expand, demand for AI talent has surged faster than the supply of qualified workers. Universities are adding courses and degrees, yet recruiters report that a lack of trained candidates slows hiring and, in some cases, product roadmaps.

Economists argue the stakes are macroeconomic. If AI boosts productivity — now growing at roughly half its pre-crisis pace — growth could accelerate. But diffusion depends on people. A shortage of trained workers will slow the spread of the new technology and the productivity gains that come with it. Online job sites report that AI-related postings have nearly doubled in two years, while searches by job-seekers rose far less, suggesting tight labor markets.

Reading Text: Closing the Gap

Part 2

Universities are trying to close the gap. At UC Berkeley, applicants to AI tracks in the EECS PhD program rose from a few hundred a decade ago to thousands last year; the entering AI cohort also grew. Illinois expanded its introductory AI course and filled extra seats within a day. Carnegie Mellon launched an undergraduate AI major, citing strong demand from students and employers.

For companies, the scarcity is costly. A chip design manager said his firm has struggled to fill AI roles “for a number of years,” slowing projects. Salaries reflect the imbalance: one jobs site estimated average posted pay for AI roles above $120,000, and some elite engineers command premium hourly rates. Firms embedding AI into products report they can hire — but it is expensive.

For students, the market is favorable. Some receive full-time offers before graduation and can choose among big tech and consumer brands. One PhD student trained in machine learning fielded multiple offers outside her original discipline, ultimately joining a major consumer goods company to optimize global shelf placement with AI. As AI adoption grows, universities, employers, and students are racing — each from a different direction — to meet in the middle.

Reading Practice: Multiple Choice

Questions 1–3

1. What is the central claim of the article?

a. AI is replacing most graduate jobs immediately.
b. AI's growth has created more demand for talent than supply.
c. University interest in AI is declining due to costs.
d. AI salaries are falling as roles standardize.

2. Which factor most directly slows AI diffusion, according to the text?

a. Hardware shortages
b. Low consumer trust
c. Shortage of trained workers
d. Strict government bans

3. The job-market imbalance is evidenced by:

a. Flat AI postings and rising searches
b. AI postings doubling while searches rose modestly
c. Fewer AI degrees but more offers
d. Lower salaries for new graduates

Reading Practice: Multiple Choice

Questions 4–6

4. What immediate impact do firms report from hiring difficulties?

a. They cancel AI projects entirely.
b. They offshore all AI work.
c. Product timelines slow.
d. They replace AI with manual processes.

5. The article frames productivity as:

a. Unrelated to AI adoption
b. Already at historical highs
c. Potentially lifted by AI if diffusion improves
d. A marketing metric, not economic

6. UC Berkeley's data mainly illustrates:

a. Lower interest in AI at PhD level
b. Dramatic growth in AI applicants and intake
c. Shift from AI to cybersecurity
d. Decline in undergraduate interest

Reading Practice: Multiple Choice

Questions 7–9

7. The Illinois course example shows:

a. AI courses are being cut
b. New seats can fill almost instantly
c. Only graduate students want AI
d. AI enrollment caps suppress demand

8. The Carnegie Mellon program indicates:

a. Employers oppose specialized AI training
b. No need for undergraduate AI
c. Institutions are creating new AI degrees
d. AI is only a minor track within CS

9. Salary evidence in the article suggests:

a. Pay is steady due to automation
b. Top AI talent can command premium rates
c. Wages drop when postings rise
d. Only startups pay well for AI

Reading Practice: Multiple Choice

Questions 10–12

10. Which group benefits most in the short term?

a. Mid-career managers with no tech skills
b. Students with AI training
c. Firms trying to cut costs
d. Consumers seeking cheaper devices

11. The "race to meet in the middle" refers to:

a. Universities lowering standards and firms lowering pay
b. Students, universities, and employers aligning supply and demand
c. Governments forcing quotas on AI jobs
d. Recruiters replacing degrees with bootcamps only

12. Which inference best matches the article's evidence?

a. AI eliminates the need for higher education.
b. Without more trained workers, AI's macro benefits may be delayed.
c. Job boards overstate demand; hiring is easy.
d. AI salaries fall when universities add programs.

Listening: Mini-Podcasts

Mini Podcast 1 — Sprint Rhythm, Not Heroics

Listen to the podcasts and fill the missing spaces with 1–2 terms that you hear.

1. A sprint is a fixed _____ that protects focus.
2. Acceptance _____ should read like a checklist.
3. Use a WIP limit to prevent review _____.
4. Build in _____ and tag a release.
5. In staging, watch p95 latency and _____ rate.
6. If metrics spike, _____ back to the previous image.
7. Assign a single _____ per step in the SOP.
8. Apply _____ privilege to service accounts.

Listening: Mini-Podcasts

Mini Podcast 2 — Security in the Flow

1. Security belongs _____ the flow, not after it.
2. Limit deploy rights using _____ control.
3. OS _____ sets safe defaults for the runtime.
4. Alerts must be _____, not noise every five minutes.
5. Add _____ detection to spot trends early.
6. Keep an _____ log to reconstruct timelines.
7. Test _____ during a quiet window and measure switchover.
8. A backup without a tested _____ is just a wish.

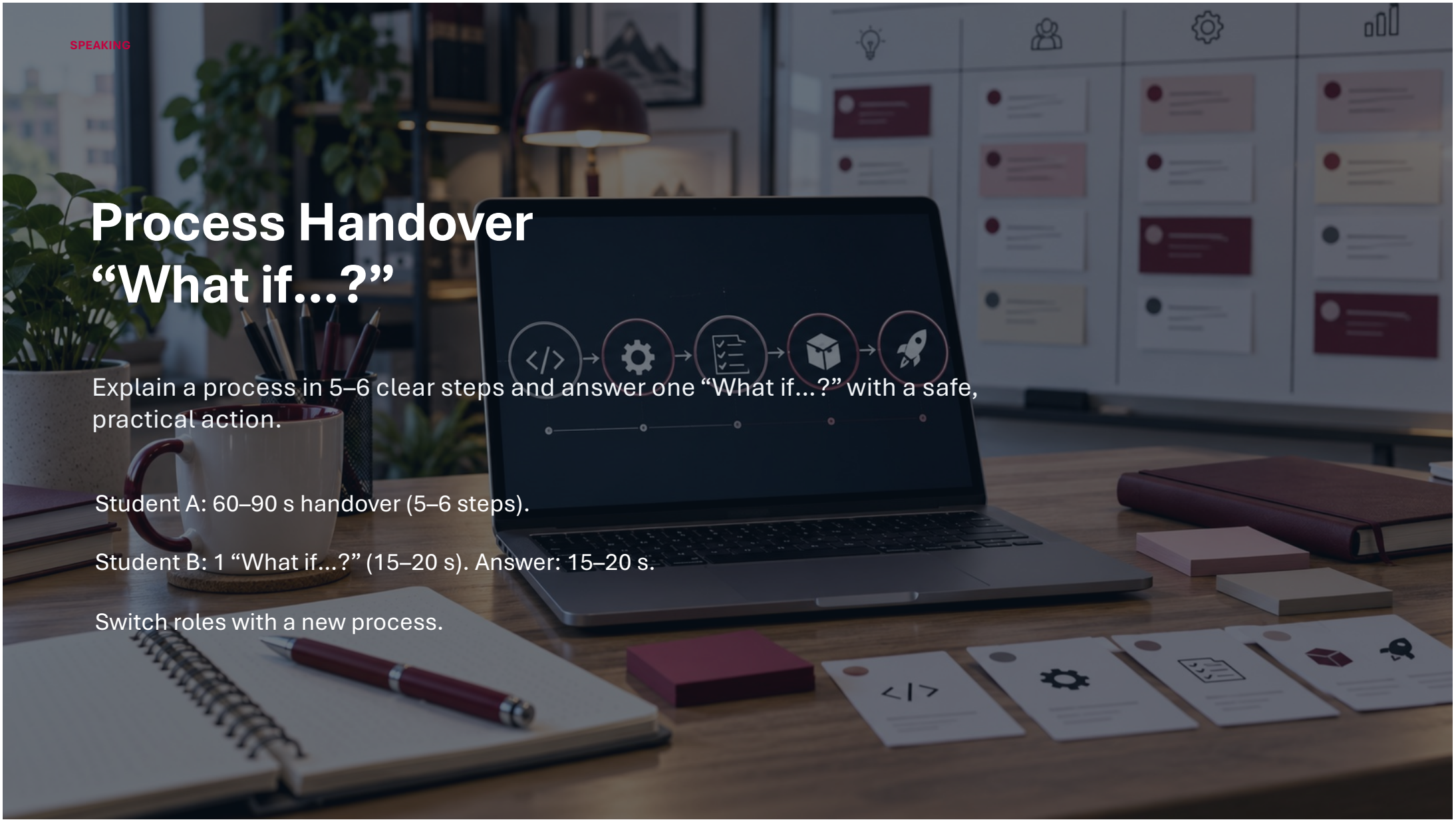
Listening: Mini-Podcasts

Mini Podcast 3 — AI as a Teammate

1. Use AI for small code _____ and edge-case tests.
2. Nighttime _____ triage is a good AI task.
3. Keep _____ in the loop before merge.
4. Treat models like dependencies: _____ versions.
5. Document failure modes—AI _____ do happen.
6. Verify on _____ before promoting to production.
7. Check if cycle time drops without higher _____ rate.
8. If the tool becomes a _____, switch it off and fall back.

SPEAKING

Process Handover “What if…?”



Explain a process in 5–6 clear steps and answer one “What if…?” with a safe, practical action.

Student A: 60–90 s handover (5–6 steps).

Student B: 1 “What if…?” (15–20 s). Answer: 15–20 s.

Switch roles with a new process.

Speaking Structure

Follow this structure to complete the speaking activity.

Stage	Useful phrase
Opening	This process covers…
Steps	First… Next… Then… After that… Finally…
Control / Safety	We check… / We do not… / We must…
What if…?	If…, we…

Useful Language

Steps, control/safety and “What if…?” answers.

Purpose	Language
Steps	First, we open the ticket. Next, we reproduce the issue in staging. Then we check the logs. After that, we apply the fix. Finally, we update the runbook.
Control / Safety	We verify the version. We do not deploy on Fridays. We follow least privilege. We never push directly to production.
What if…?	If the build fails, we check the dependencies. If the deploy breaks, we roll back to the previous image. If an alert fires, we tail the logs and escalate.

Core Vocabulary

Use at least six Unit 2 terms in your handover.

Category	Vocabulary
Stages	backlog, sprint, build, staging, production
Tools / roles	CI pipeline, orchestrator, monitoring dashboard, on-call
Process / data	user story, acceptance criteria, environment variables, audit log, release tag
Actions	refine the backlog, run the tests, deploy to staging, roll back the release, escalate the blocker, set a WIP limit

Speaking Scenarios

Choose one process and prepare the handover.

Sprint flow: backlog → build → test → deploy

Failed deploy: detect → roll back → handoff

Security check in the pipeline: access control → hardening → audit log

Speaking Requirements

Checklist before presenting.

5–6 ordered steps

1 control/safety point

1 “What if…?” with a clear answer

≥6 Unit 2 terms + 2 signposting phrases

Time: 90–120 seconds total per turn

Register: professional, short sentences, clear numbers

Mini Grammar Pill

Giving advice and making suggestions.

Form	Use	Example
should + infinitive	advice	We should investigate the root cause.
could + infinitive	possible solution	We could organise a meeting with the development team.
need to + infinitive	necessary action	We need to fix the bug before the next deployment.

⚠️ Remember: After should and could, use the infinitive without “to”.

Incorrect	Correct
We should to check the server.	We should check the server.

Writing

Formal or semi-formal email: 120–150 words.

You are working as part of an IT development team in a company. During the current project, your team has encountered a problem that is affecting the work and could delay the project.

Your email must:

1. Explain briefly what the problem is and how it is affecting the project.
2. Propose a date, time and place for a meeting to discuss the situation.
3. Explain what you would like to discuss during the meeting, including possible solutions or next steps.
4. Ask your colleagues to confirm whether they can attend or suggest another time.

Writing: Choose the Problem

Choose one of these situations for your email.

Problem	Description
Task Delays	A team member regularly misses deliverable deadlines, delaying overall project completion.
Unequal Workload Distribution	Work tasks are distributed unevenly, creating bottlenecks and friction in the team.

Use Unit 2 vocabulary: blocker, bottleneck, handoff, workaround, escalation, WIP limit, root cause.

Structure of the Email

Use this model to organise your message.

Subject: Proposed Meeting: Addressing [Issue / Workflow Bottleneck]

Dear Team / Hi everyone,

I am writing to arrange a brief meeting to discuss a recent issue regarding [briefly state problem] and its impact on our project timeline.

Currently, this situation is causing [explain consequence, e.g., delays in handoff / increased error rates]. To address this effectively, I would like to propose a meeting on [Date] at [Time] in [Location / Online Link].

During the meeting, we should focus on:
1. Reviewing current process bottlenecks.
2. Discussing potential workarounds and task reallocation.
3. Agreeing on revised delivery deadlines.

Please confirm if this time works for you or suggest an alternative slot.

Kind regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Role]


THANKS!
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